THE LOOKING GLASS BEAUTY SCHOOL

A02 Theory Assessment Paper

Written assessment, 38 questions, 50 marks. Pass mark 40 (80%). Closed book. Time allowed: 60 minutes.

Liquid and Powder Acrylic Enhancement CPD Course | Course author: Jessica Jane Preston | Version 1.3, November 2026

Learner name: _____ Date: _____ Tutor: _____

Instructions: Section 1 has 28 multiple-choice questions worth 1 mark each (circle one answer). Section 2 has 8 short-answer questions worth 2 marks each. Section 3 has 2 scenario questions worth 3 marks each. Answer every question. Any answer that instructs using MMA or an unlabelled product, applying product onto living tissue, working with a wet bead, filing without extraction, prising or drilling an enhancement off, electric-file work on the natural nail, or concealing an active infection must be corrected with the tutor before a pass is awarded, whatever the score. Reasonable adjustments (extra time, questions read aloud, oral answers recorded by the tutor, large print) are available on request and do not change the pass mark.

Section 1: multiple choice (28 marks)

1. The liquid in a professional liquid-and-powder system is mainly:

a) Polymer powder in suspension
b) Monomer, normally ethyl methacrylate (EMA), with a catalyst
c) Acetone
d) Primer

2. What starts the bead setting?

a) The lamp
b) The liquid wetting the powder and releasing the initiator
c) Heat from the client's hand
d) The primer

3. A bead that runs, spreads on its own and floods the sidewalls is:

a) Too dry
b) Correct
c) Too wet
d) Already set

4. The most common cause of both lifting and acrylate allergy is:

a) Wet beads and product on the skin
b) Too much powder in the bead
c) A cold room
d) Filing the free edge with 180 grit

5. Set time is shortened by:

a) A cold room
b) A warmer room and a larger bead
c) A wetter bead
d) Smaller beads

6. Methyl methacrylate (MMA) liquid in Great Britain is:

a) Listed as a prohibited substance in Annex II
b) Not listed as prohibited, but unsafe for nail use; some licensing authorities prohibit it by name
c) The standard professional monomer
d) Only found in powders

7. A warning sign of an MMA-type product is:

a) It sets slowly
b) It will not soak off in acetone in a reasonable time
c) It smells like your usual monomer
d) It comes with a Safety Data Sheet

8. Where does the apex belong?

a) At the free edge
b) At the cuticle area
c) In the back third of the finished nail, supporting the stress area
d) It does not matter

9. Strength in an enhancement comes from:

a) Thickness
b) Shape: a correctly placed apex, even C-curve and straight sidewalls
c) The primer
d) The tip

10. Zone 2 is:

a) The free edge or extension
b) The stress area and the apex
c) The cuticle area
d) The underside

11. The natural nail plate should meet nothing coarser than:

a) 80 grit
b) 100 grit
c) 180 grit
d) 240 grit

12. The 100 side of a 100/180 file is for:

a) De-shining the natural nail
b) Shaping and reducing set product only
c) The cuticle area
d) Blending a tip into the natural nail

13. Source-capture extraction means:

a) A desk fan
b) An extractor at the point of filing that draws dust away from both faces
c) An open window
d) A paper mask

14. A paper or fabric face covering is:

a) Suitable respiratory protection
b) Not respiratory protection
c) Required by HSE for nail work
d) A COSHH engineering control

15. The dappen dish should be:

a) Left open so the monomer can breathe
b) Lidded whenever you are not drawing from it
c) Filled for the whole day
d) Emptied into the sink

16. A tip should be:

a) Narrower than the nail and pinched on
b) Fitted sidewall to sidewall with its C-curve matched to the natural nail
c) Glued across the whole plate
d) Blended through the join into the natural nail

17. A gap under a sculpting form:

a) Is acceptable if small
b) Lets product reach living tissue and traps moisture
c) Improves the C-curve
d) Speeds the set

18. A hairline gap at the cuticle area is:

a) A flaw to be filled
b) Correct technique
c) Only used with gel
d) Filled at the infill

19. An infill that fills the regrowth without rebalancing:

a) Is the standard service
b) Moves the apex forward each visit until the nail breaks at the stress area
c) Is quicker and just as good
d) Is the same as a removal

20. Fresh product over a lifted edge:

a) Is fine if the edge is small
b) Traps moisture and bacteria and is never done
c) Saves time at an infill
d) Is how a repair is done

21. A typical acetone soak for acrylic, after the bulk has been reduced, takes:

a) 2 minutes
b) 20 to 30 minutes

c) 2 hours
d) Overnight at home

22. Before soaking you:

a) Prise the enhancement up to let the acetone in
b) Reduce the bulk with a hand file, leaving a thin layer
c) File down to the natural nail
d) Drill it off

23. Green discolouration under lifted product is most often:

a) 'Green fungus'
b) Bacterial colonisation, commonly Pseudomonas, in a moist space
c) A bruise
d) Pigment from the powder

24. Which of these means the service is refused?

a) A few stable white spots on one nail
b) A swollen, red, tender nail fold with pus present
c) Short, bitten nails with intact skin
d) A client who asks for almond nails

25. Primer is applied:

a) To the skin and the nail
b) Sparingly, to the plate only, as the manufacturer directs
c) Generously, for better adhesion
d) After the first bead

26. Under COSHH the first step is to:

a) Buy gloves
b) Assess the risk from the actual products and tasks, using their Safety Data Sheets
c) Open a window
d) Ask the client about allergies

27. Which claim is acceptable under ASA/CAP guidance?

a) 'Guaranteed not to lift for three weeks'
b) 'Designed to last between infills; wear varies with nail condition, lifestyle and aftercare'
c) 'Repairs damaged nails'
d) 'Allergy-free'

28. An electric file on the natural nail on this course is:

a) Taught in the afternoon
b) Not taught or assessed; it needs separate, specific training
c) Used for removal
d) Used to blend tips

Section 2: short answer (16 marks, 2 each)

29. Describe a correct bead, and say what a wet bead does to the client.

_____
_____
_____

30. Name the four things a balanced nail needs.

_____
_____
_____

31. Give three things that change the set time of a bead.

_____
_____
_____

32. Why is a hairline gap at the cuticle area correct technique, and what does product on the skin lead to?

_____
_____
_____

33. Explain the difference between an infill and a rebalance, and why every maintenance appointment does both.

_____
_____
_____

34. Name three warning signs of an MMA-type product and state what you do about it.

_____
_____
_____

35. Name the two exposures specific to acrylic work and one control for each.

_____
_____
_____

36. Before you take health information at the consultation, what must the client be given or told under data protection law?

_____
_____
_____

Section 3: scenarios (6 marks, 3 each)

37. Scenario A. A regular client arrives with three nails lifted at the cuticle area and one with a crack through the stress area. She has a wedding in four days. Set out your assessment, what you do to each nail, what you say about the crack, and what you record.

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_____
_____
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38. Scenario B. Midway through a set you notice the beads are spreading and flooding the sidewalls, and the room is warmer than usual. Explain what is happening, what you change, and why leaving it would matter beyond appearance.

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_____
_____
_____

For tutor use

Section 1 /28	Section 2 /16	Section 3 /6	Total /50	Pass (40+) Y / N	Safety-critical errors corrected Y / N / none

Tutor signature: _____ Date: _____ Learner signature: _____